



GIVE THE SUN THE BLOOD OF ENEMIES TO DRINK

THE FOUNDATION OF TENOCHTITLAN (1325)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

The Aztec and Inca empires

BEFORE

c. 1200 Emergence of the Incas in the Cuzco valley, Peru.

c. 1250 Aztecs arrive in the Valley of Mexico.

1300 Aztecs establish settlements on land owned by the lord of Culhuacán.

1325 Aztecs flee south from Culhuacán and enter the land around Lake Texcoco.

AFTER

1376 Acamapichtli becomes the first Aztec ruler.

1428 Inca expansion begins.

Establishment of the Aztec Triple Alliance.

c. 1470 Incas capture Chimor, center of the Chimú culture.

1519 Spanish arrive in Mexico.

1532 Spanish arrive in Peru.

In 1325, a band of Central American refugee warriors, known as the Aztecs, saw a sign their patron god Huitzilopochtli had long ago prophesied—an eagle perched on a cactus, marking the spot they had been told to settle. Before long, they had built a temple that became the nucleus of their capital, Tenochtitlan.

Small, competing states in central Mexico and Peru **attract Aztec and Inca migrants** who fill the power vacuum.

The Aztecs and Incas found capital cities at Tenochtitlan and Cuzco respectively.

The Aztec Empire expands using military **aggression** and **fear of reprisals** to **retain power**.

The Inca empire expands by **coopting conquered peoples** and seeking to **integrate** them.

Neither model of empire can survive the **Spanish invasion**.

Within two centuries, the city was the center of the most predominant empire in the history of Mesoamerica—a large region that shared a pre-Columbian culture and extended from modern-day central Mexico southward to Belize, Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua, and northern Costa Rica. This progress was paralleled by the growth at much the same time of Cuzco, the capital of the Incas—an Andean people of humble beginnings, who in just a few decades created the largest state South America had yet seen.